

Kihwan Kim

Software Engineer · 7 years — deploying AI systems and connecting them to business value

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SUMMARY

Software engineer with 7 years of experience turning ambiguous problems into deployed AI solutions and usable products. Background in HCI and Visual Analytics research on human–AI collaboration; since then I have embedded with operations teams and non-expert users to turn scattered tools and model outputs into end-to-end solutions — from an AutoML platform for non-experts to agent-based operations automation. I own problems from discovery through production and connect technical work to business outcomes.

EXPERIENCE

Levvels — Software Engineer

2025.07 – Present

AI-native product development and internal operations automation.

- Embedded with the operations team, scoped how they carried state across several internal tools to make one decision, and deployed an agent-based automation (PageAgent) that cut hours of manual investigation to minutes; fed field insights back into the product
- Built the AI character chat experience: separated in-progress streamed responses from persisted history and designed a send / complete / fail / regenerate state machine over SSE
- Built and maintained commerce frontend (consumer web, creator studio, admin) across discovery, checkout, and post-order flows

React · Next.js · TypeScript · SSE · Node.js · PageAgent

RIDI Corp. — Frontend Engineer

2022.05 – 2025.07

Large, high-traffic content platform.

- Rendered server-declared UI on the client to decouple screen changes from deploys; migrated legacy PHP pages toward React incrementally to lower risk
- Optimized large-list rendering with windowing and dynamic heights; used Redis to cache server-driven UI payloads; tracked real-user errors with Sentry

React · Next.js · TypeScript · Server-driven UI · Redis · Virtualization

TmaxEnterprise — Research Engineer

2020.02 – 2022.05

Made complex AI and analytics usable for non-experts — usability and explainability first.

- Built a codeless studio so users without model-development experience could build and operate models on an AutoML platform
- Developed explainable-AI (XAI) visualizations that show the reasoning beside the prediction, so a non-expert has a basis to act

EDUCATION

Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology (UNIST)

2013.03 – 2020.02

- **M.S. in Computer Science and Engineering** — 2018.03 – 2020.02 · research in Human–Computer Interaction and Visual Analytics (human–AI collaboration)
- **B.S. in Technology Management** — 2013.03 – 2018.02 · multi-disciplinary majors: Technology Management / Information Systems / Entrepreneurship, and Computer Science and Engineering

MILITARY SERVICE

Completed — Technical Research Personnel (전문연구요원), a 3-year alternative military service fulfilled across the TmaxEnterprise (2020.02 – 2022.05) and RIDI Corp. roles above; continued at RIDI Corp. after completing the service.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Kihwan Kim**. “An Empirical Analysis on Transparent Algorithmic Exploration in Recommender Systems.” CoRR 2021 · arxiv.org/abs/2108.00151
- Cheonbok Park, Chunggi Lee, Hyojin Bahng, Yunwon Tae, **Kihwan Kim**, Seungmin Jin, Sungahn Ko, Jaegul Choo. “ST-GRAT: A Novel Spatio-temporal Graph Attention Network for Accurately Forecasting Dynamically Changing Road Speed.” CIKM 2020 · dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3340531.3411940
- **Kihwan Kim**, Sanghoon Kim, Chunggi Lee, Sungahn Ko. “Modeling Exploration/Exploitation Decisions through Mobile Sensing for Understanding Mechanisms of Addiction.” MobiSys 2019 · dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3307334.3328599
- Juyoung Oh, Chunggi Lee, Hwiyeon Kim, **Kihwan Kim**, Osang Kwon, Eric D. Ragan, Bum Chul Kwon, Sungahn Ko. “An Empirical Study on the Relationship Between the Number of Coordinated Views and Visual Analysis.” CoRR · arxiv.org/abs/2204.09524
- Jaesung Lee, **Kihwan Kim**, Chunggi Lee, Sungahn Ko. “A Survey of Visualization Techniques for Interpreting Deep Learning.” Noise & Vibration (journal) 2017 · dbpia.co.kr

SKILLS

- **Frontend / Full-stack:** React, Next.js, TypeScript, Node.js, SSE, server-driven UI, large-scale rendering / virtualization
- **AI in production:** LLM streaming UI, agent-based automation, explainable AI, output verification with AI coding tools (Claude Code)

OPEN SOURCE

OpenMMO — Contributor 2026.07 – Present
Open-source MMORPG where AI agents and humans play through the same protocol (Rust · Svelte · WebAssembly).

- 10 PRs merged, owning changes end-to-end from the TypeScript client into the Rust server — cache eviction, account bans, trade validation.

vite-plus — Contributor 2026.08
Toolchain from VoidZero — the team behind Vite and Vitest (Rust · TypeScript).

- Fixed a shell-integration bug in Rust (dropped working-directory flag) and covered the four shells’ templates with snapshot tests — merged (#2508).

No employment gaps between the roles above. Additional details, case studies, and portfolio at kihwan.kim.